

!Chess

Game Design Document

Rodrigo Valente n 20250159

Teresa Gamito n 20250161

Table of Contents

1. About this Document.....	3
2. Version history.....	4
3. Introduction.....	5
3.1. Game Overview.....	5
4. Design.....	6
4.1. MDA Framework.....	6
4.2. Game Difficulty.....	6
4.3. Level Design.....	6
4.4. Tutorial Design.....	7
4.5. Game Testing Plan.....	7
5. Gameplay Basics.....	8
5.1. Core Gameplay Loop.....	8
5.2. Gameplay Aspects.....	8
5.2.1. Board.....	8
5.2.1.1. Pieces.....	8
5.2.1.2. Tiles.....	8
5.2.2. Upgrade Tree.....	8
5.2.3. Capturing Points.....	8
5.3. Controls.....	9
5.4. Camera.....	9
5.5. Secondary Gameplay Loops.....	9
5.5.1. Adding pieces to the board.....	9
5.5.2. Sacrificing Pieces.....	9
5.5.3. Editing Pieces / Tiles.....	10
5.6. UI.....	10
5.6.1. Game board.....	10
5.6.2. Upgrade Tree.....	10
5.6.3. History of Moves.....	10
5.6.4. Properties.....	10
5.6.5. Player Information.....	10
5.6.6. Rules.....	10
5.6.7. Options tab.....	10
5.7. Action.....	10
6. Board.....	11
6.1. Pieces.....	11
6.1.1. Pawn.....	12
6.1.2. Rook.....	12
6.1.3. Knight.....	12
6.1.4. Bishop.....	13
6.1.5. Queen.....	13
6.1.6. King.....	13
6.1.7. Lance and Promoted Lance (shogi lance).....	14
6.1.8. Checkers piece (checkers game) and Promoted Checkers piece.....	14

6.2. Tiles.....	15
6.2.1. Regular.....	15
6.2.2. Wall.....	15
6.2.3. Poison.....	15
7. Upgrade Tree.....	16
7.1. Description.....	16
7.2. Table of nodes.....	16
7.3. Planification.....	20
8. UI.....	21
8.1. Pause / Turn Number / Game Switch Button.....	21
8.2. Player Info.....	21
8.3. Game / Upgrade Tree Window.....	22
8.4. Properties Tab.....	22
8.5. Active Rules Tab.....	23
8.6. History Tab.....	23
9. Rules (and non traditional rules).....	25
9.1. Capturing and points.....	25
9.2. Promotion.....	25
10. Game State Sketches.....	26
11. Menus and Screens.....	28
11.1. Main Menu.....	28
11.2. Pause Menu.....	28
12. Art.....	29
12.1. Direction.....	29
12.2. Reference Images.....	29
13. Audio.....	30
13.1. Direction.....	30
13.2. Table of Reference.....	30
14. Known Bugs / Unimplemented Features.....	31
15. Glossary.....	32
16. Brilliant ideas.....	33

1. About this Document

Progress Document:  Progress Reference this document for progress of each section of the game development process

This document assumes that:

- The reader knows about the game of chess as well as its rules, mechanics and common representations and adaptations throughout different cultures (Chess, Shogi, Xiangqi).
- That the two players are represented as “white” or “black”, player 1 is white and player 2 is black.
- The board is set in a coordinate system with A - H for the x axis and 1 - 8 for the y axis with A1 as the bottom left corner where the white rook typically starts as.

Highlighted words have different interpretations, explained as the following labels:

- **Yellow highlighted text** - needs revision
- **Blue highlighted text** - needs reference
- **Green highlighted text** - needs asking
- **Pink highlighted text** - needs to be added information

Certain words are referenced in the glossary section that redirect to their specific definition or are explained directly

Certain content of this document is not implemented as the game is built, those sections are represented with ~~cut words~~.

This document is flexible and can be changed over the course of the development of the game. Additionally, the game mechanics are prone to not being balanced and such they can be altered as well.

The version history starts when the main structure of the game is defined and written down for the first time. After that, all changes are described and noted as follows:

- Major changes of gameplay and other aspects of the game version
x.x.x -> x+1.x.x
- Minor changes to gameplay and other aspects of the game that are noticeable
x.x.x -> x.x+1.x
- Document related corrections, text fixes
x.x.x -> x.x.x+1

2. Version history

1.3.2 - added MDA framework

1.3.1 - cleaned up wording and document formatting

1.3.0 - added a more in-depth explanation of controls

1.2.1 - added more visual support

1.2.0 - added tables and more in-depth piece and upgrade tree nodes

1.1.0 - added more information regarding pieces and board tiles, restructured document, other changes

1.0.1 - Updated minor information and corrected spelling

1.0.0 - GDD created, set up main structure

3. Introduction

3.1. Game Overview

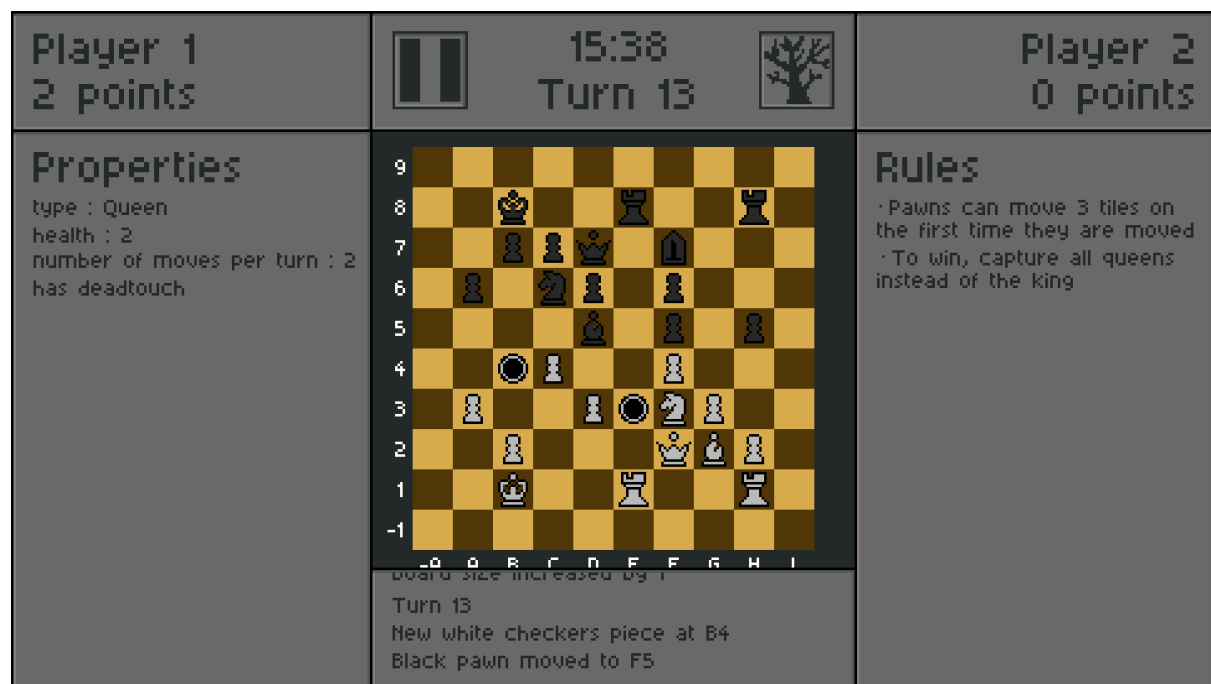
!Chess is a 2D local 1 vs 1 top-down competitive strategy game for Windows PC, Linux and Mac where both players engage in a game of chess that gets progressively more chaotic as different rules and actions are unlocked through a shared upgrade tree.

The game consists of two main aspects:

- The game board, where both players take turns to either move a piece on the board or unlock and use a point on the upgrade tree.
- The upgrade tree is shared by both players, and contains nodes that can be unlocked for the session and can change or add aspects to the game.

The game is represented through a set of different windows and pop-ups that display the game board, upgrade tree, properties and history of actions as well as other UI elements.

The game ends when one of the players fulfills the win conditions such as capturing the opponent's king (but more win conditions can be set throughout the development of the game).



Early mockup of the game in the middle of a session

4. Design

4.1. MDA Framework

By adding ways to change the rules and properties of chess while maintaining the core concepts of the game it is possible to create a wider array of new and orthodox ways for the player to achieve victory, this method is somewhat similar of that of classic strategic rpg's where the players have access to different types of playstyle.

Making these changes makes the game more casual in nature by adding a power balance so that there is a better possibility of a comeback after one player makes some mistakes (something that in normal chess can determine the conclusion of the match).

In conclusion, by making the element of creativity heavily impact the game, players feel more inclined to try new game strategies, creating their own and adding a lot of replayability.

4.2. Game Difficulty

Since both players have access to all of the game's features one major factor of difficulty is the adaptability of a player towards the ever changing state of board, rules and properties.

In the early game, having knowledge of basic chess rules and strategies will be enough.

Mid-game is where the game starts adding new mechanics like a wider board, making it more difficult to keep track of pieces that are in a dangerous position, and the addition of other board game pieces.

Late-game is where managing resources becomes the main skill needed to gain advantage, at this point both players are bound to make mistakes, there is a lot of chaos on the board, so the player with better understanding of where he should focus his attention and what combination of all the information given can achieve a victory.

4.3. Level Design

The starting level design follows the original game of chess layout. There are almost no modifications besides some rules, like castling or en passant, that by nature will hinder the development of the game, regarding the layout, it keeps the classic look in order to give more emphasis on the "surprise" when in later turns, the game becomes a complete chaos with almost no comparison to traditional chess.

The upgrade tree is the part of the game that requires the most amount of attention to design since it what most affects the balance and aesthetics of the game. The main aspect that the tree brings to the development of a match is chaos in the form of having an overwhelming variety of interactions between the two players. More is detailed on the [upgrade tree section](#)

4.4. Tutorial Design

There is no tutorial since the appeal of the game comes from the players figuring out the rules and interactions by themselves with the help of, property tab, rules tab and the description in each node for better understanding.

Instead of a tutorial, players have available to them all of the information about any aspect of the game at any time.

Since the game builds up in complexity with the development of a match, players have the capacity to learn about the aspects of the game by themselves while they play.

4.5. Game Testing Plan

After the completion of the prototype and the playable physical version (which contain few additions to normal chess), testing will start:

- Adding a few features
- Having different players play the game as the current version
- Make adjustments based on the feedback from the players

The main areas that will be tested are:

- Upgrades on the upgrade tree
- Balance of costs and abilities
- Complexity and player understanding
- Player feel
- UI feel

5. Gameplay Basics

5.1. Core Gameplay Loop

The game starts as a regular chess match with one player as white and the other as black (white takes the first turn) in a regular 8x8 board with the common pieces found in the game (Pawn, Rook, Knight, Bishop, Queen and King). Aside from the board there is a shared upgrade tree in which the players can spend points to unlock its contents. Points are gained by capturing an enemy piece. Each player takes turns to either move a piece they own (or not, depending on the current rules of the game) or spend points to unlock a node in the upgrade tree. The game ends when one player meets all the win requirements (such as capturing the opponent's king).

5.2. Gameplay Aspects

5.2.1. Board

The board of the game starts out with the regular layout of chess pieces and a 8x8 checkered tile board.

5.2.1.1. Pieces

Starting out with Pawn, Rook, Knight, Bishop, Queen and King. Throughout the game other pieces can be added or the existing ones can be modified.

Pieces can have multiple properties such as health points, number of moves, status effects, level and others. These properties are added as the game progresses when the players interact with the upgrade tree

5.2.1.2. Tiles

8x8 board of tiles in a checkerboard pattern of white and black.

The size of the board and the properties of the tiles can change over the course of the game when players interact with the upgrade tree.

Tiles can have multiple properties such as being unpassable or being dangerous in some way.

5.2.2. Upgrade Tree

The upgrade tree consists of a graph that contains certain rules, upgrades or consumable actions that can be unlocked depending on the chosen node selected.

The upgrade tree starts with five unlocked nodes that can be purchased by either player on their turn as soon as they have enough points to spend. These nodes are connected to other nodes that start out as locked and can be unlocked when all connected previous nodes are purchased.

Each player can spend points to purchase unlocked nodes during their turn.

5.2.3. Capturing Points

Points are obtained by capturing an opponent's piece.

Points can be spent to unlock sections of the upgrade tree.

Different pieces reward different amounts of capturing points. (for example: a pawn is valued at 1 point while a rook is 2)

5.3. Controls

The game can be controlled exclusively with a mouse. Some actions can also be performed with keyboard shortcuts.

The mouse left click selects settings and actions all over the game.

The mouse right click deselects actions or returns from menus.

Keyboard keys can be used to select certain actions and menus such as using the esc key to pop up the pause menu or return from an action.

The upgrade tree and board are displayed on a scrollable map that can be zoomed in and out since their size can not be convenient to display on a regular screen.

5.4. Camera

The game has a top-down perspective of a squared grid board

During the game, the screen focuses on all of the elements of the board, upgrade tree and UI at the same time. Both the board and the tree are scrollable maps that can be moved with the mouse.

5.5. Secondary Gameplay Loops

5.5.1. Adding pieces to the board

When a node on the upgrade tree is purchased by a player and this node enables them to add a piece to the board, the player is then prompted to choose a tile on their side of the board (counting that the board can be divided equally horizontally) where to add the piece this can only be done in a valid tile.

A valid tile to add a piece is one where there are no other pieces already present and the tile itself is walkable (not a wall tile). If the player's side of the board is already full then the action of adding the piece is skipped.

After the player adds the piece to the board, their turn ends and the opponent's turn starts.

If the node purchased also allows the opponent to add a piece, when their turn starts, the opponent can choose where to add that piece on a valid tile. After this, the opponent's turn starts.

5.5.2. Sacrificing Pieces

When a node on the upgrade tree is purchased by a player and this node enables them to sacrifice a piece they possess, the player is then prompted to choose one of their pieces to sacrifice (depending on the action of the node). The player's turn ends after this.

If the opponent also needs to sacrifice one of their pieces, then they are also prompted at the beginning of their turn and then their turn starts.

5.5.3. Editing Pieces / Tiles

When a node on upgrade tree is purchased by a player and the is node allows the player to edit or modify a piece or tile, then the player can freely choose the affected piece/tile depending on the rules expressed by the node.

5.6. UI

5.6.1. Game board

Displays the game that contains the board and pieces.

5.6.2. Upgrade Tree

Displays the upgrade tree that allows the players to shape the game's actions.

5.6.3. History of Moves

Displays the history of moves made by pieces on the board, unlocks on the upgrade tree or consumable actions used.

5.6.4. Properties

Displays the current properties of a tile or piece.

5.6.5. Player Information

Displays the name of the player and the capturing points they can spend.

5.6.6. Rules

Display the current added rules in the game.

5.6.7. Options tab

Displays the current time the player playing has left, a pause button that when pressed pauses the game and opens the pause menu pop-up and a button that allows the players to visually switch which screen is being displayed between the upgrade tree and the game board.

5.7. Action

Each player can either move a piece on the board or unlock a path on the upgrade tree.

Certain actions are not restricted such as accessing menus or viewing pieces and tiles' properties.

6. Board

The game starts as a simple game of chess: an 8x8 grid of checkerboard tiles, each player controls a king, a queen, two bishops, two knights, two rooks and eight pawns.

For reference consider a board of 8x8 tiles set as a graph with the positions A - H being on the x axis and 1 - 8 being on the y axis and with the starting point A1 being on the white side.

This section describes each different piece and tile type in the game. More pieces and tiles can be added throughout the game besides the starting ones. Apart from adding, these can also be modified or have additional properties (refer to the [upgrade tree section](#) for the means to achieve these alterations on the game).

6.1. Pieces

This section describes in detail every piece in the game, this list is flexible and can change with the development of the game

For quick access refer to the following table:

Name	Quick details	Capturing points awarded	Section link
Pawn	Moves one or two tiles forward on the first move and on subsequent moves only one tile. Captures diagonally (plus en passant)	1	Pawn
Rook	Moves any number of tiles in any cardinal direction	2	Rook
Knight	Moves in an L shape (two tiles in one direction and one in the perpendicular way)	2	Knight
Bishop	Moves any number of tiles in any diagonal direction	2	Bishop
Queen	Same movement as the rook and bishop combined	3	Queen
King	Moves one tile in any cardinal and diagonal directions	Win	King
Lance	Unpromoted: moves any number of tiles forward Promoted: moves one tile in any cardinal and diagonal directions except for diagonally back	Unpromoted - 1 Promoted - 2	Lance
Checker s piece	Unpromoted: moves one tile diagonally forward Promoted: same movement as the bishop Capturing: jumps over the piece if there is an empty tile to land on	Unpromoted - 1 Promoted - 2	Checker s piece

6.1.1. Pawn

Placement - The game starts with the row 2 for white and 7 for black with a pawn on each tile

Movement - The first time moving a pawn, the player can choose to move it one or two tiles above. On subsequent moves of the same pawn, the player can only move one tile at a time.

Capturing - A pawn can only capture other pieces that are directly diagonally above itself, except for the case where the opponent moved a pawn two tiles on the turn before, with this the pawn can capture the opposing pawn as if the opponent's only had moved one tile, this move is known as *en passant*.

Promoting - A pawn can be promoted to a queen, bishop, knight or rook.

Points - capturing a pawn rewards the player that captured it one capturing point



Pawn icon

6.1.2. Rook

Placement - The game starts with a rook on each corner of the board, A1 and H1 tiles contain a white rook in each and A8 and H8 are black

Movement - The rook can move any number of tiles in any cardinal direction unless there is a piece blocking the path

Capturing - With its movement, if there is an opponent piece on the way, the rook can capture it by taking its place.

Points - Capturing a rook awards the player that captured it two capturing points



Rook icon

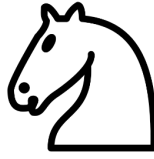
6.1.3. Knight

Placement - Each player starts with two knights, B1 and G1 tiles contain a white knight each and B8 and G8 are black

Movement - The knight can move in an L shape: one tile to one direction and two to the perpendicular direction ignoring other pieces on its path

Capturing - With its movement, if there is an opponent piece on the final tile, the knight can capture it by taking its place

Points - Capturing a knight awards the player that captured it two capturing points



Knight icon

6.1.4. Bishop

Placement - Each player starts with two bishops, C1 and F1 tiles contain a white bishop each and C8 and F8 are black

Movement - The bishop can move any number of tiles in any diagonal unless there is a piece blocking the path

Capturing - With its movement, if there is an opponent piece on the way, the bishop can capture it by taking its place.

Points - Capturing a bishop awards the player that captured it two capturing points



Bishop icon

6.1.5. Queen

Placement - Each player starts with one queen, white at E1 and black at E8.

Movement - The queen can move in the same fashion as the rook and the bishop at the same time

Capturing - With its movement, if there is an opponent piece on the way, the queen can capture it by taking its place.

Points - Capturing a queen awards the player that captured it three capturing points



Queen icon

6.1.6. King

Placement - Each player starts with one king, white at F1 and black at F8.

Movement - The king can only move one tile in any cardinal direction or diagonal

Capturing - With its movement, if there is an opponent piece on the way, the king can capture it by taking its place.

Points - Capturing a king ends the game with the victory of the player that captured it



King icon

6.1.7. Lance and Promoted Lance (shogi lance)

This piece is the same as the lance from the game of shogi and can be promoted by reaching the same promoting conditions as the pawn and gets promoted to a promoted lance

Lance:

Placement - Added to the game under a player's control via the upgrade tree

Movement - The lance can only move forward any number of tiles on the vertical direction

Capturing - With its movement, if there is an opponent piece on the way, the lance can capture it by taking its place.

Points - Capturing a lance awards the player that captured it two capturing points

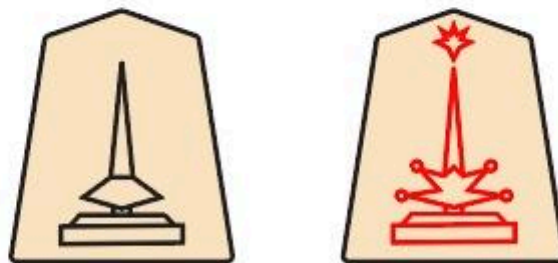
Promoting - Changes to a promoted lance

Promoted lance:

Movement - The promoted lance can move one tile at a time direction in any direction surrounding it (cardinal directions and diagonals) except for moving backwards diagonally

Capturing - With its movement, if there is an opponent piece on the way, the lance can capture it by taking its place.

Points - Capturing a promoted lance awards the player that captured it two capturing points



Lance (left) and Promoted Lance (right) icons

6.1.8. Checkers piece (checkers game) and Promoted Checkers piece

This piece is the same as a piece of checkers from the game of checkers

Checker's piece:

Placement - Added to the game under a player's control via the upgrade tree

Movement - The checkers piece can only move one tile forward diagonally

Capturing - If there is a piece on the tile this piece could move to, and the tile diagonally next in a straight line is not occupied, this piece jumps over the target piece and captures it, landing on the empty tile

Points - Capturing a checkers piece awards the player that captured it one capturing point

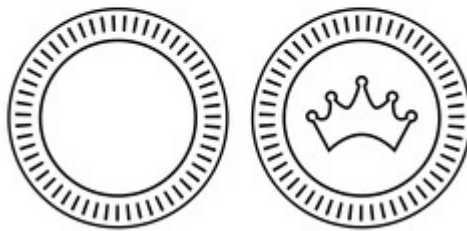
Promotion - Changes to a promoted checkers' piece

Checker's piece:

Movement - The promoted checkers piece can move any number of tiles in any diagonal direction

Capturing - Captures the same way as an unpromoted checkers piece

Points - Capturing a promoted checkers piece awards the player that captured it two capturing point



Checkers piece (left) and Promoted Checkers piece (right) icons

6.2. Tiles

The board starts with a grid of 8x8 tiles in a checkerboard pattern with the white king starting position being a black tile. (black and white tiles are the colors associated to the checkerboard pattern)

6.2.1. Regular

Regular tiles have no defining characteristics and allow for free movement of pieces

6.2.2. Wall

A piece can't move through this if they could if this was a regular tile.

Pieces can't exist on these tiles.

To set a tile to a wall tile, this tile must be empty.

6.2.3. Poison

A piece that stays here for more than one turn is lost (removed from the board without awarding points to any player)

7. Upgrade Tree

7.1. Description

The upgrade tree is a series of nodes connected to each other in order that start out as locked (except the starting ones) and can be unlocked and purchased when the previous unlocked ones are purchased.

There are five starting nodes that are unlocked when starting the game and that can be purchased immediately. These nodes then are connected to other ones and these are connected to furthermore and so on.

Different nodes can have different costs.

Players can purchase these nodes by spending capturing points.

Each node can only be purchased once.

A purchased node affects the player / players in the perspective of the player who purchased it (“add a pawn” gives the player who purchased the node the ability to add a pawn under their command).

7.2. Table of nodes

This section describes the nodes present on the upgrade tree

Designs and descriptions are not final and more can be added freely throughout the development of the game (this section is extremely flexible and

Labels:

- Buyer: the player that purchased the node (spent capturing points)
- Add a piece to the player’s side of the board: the player can add the indicated piece in any unoccupied tile within the half of the board (horizontally) that is closest to the player
- Rule: add a permanent rule until the end of the game, this affects both players

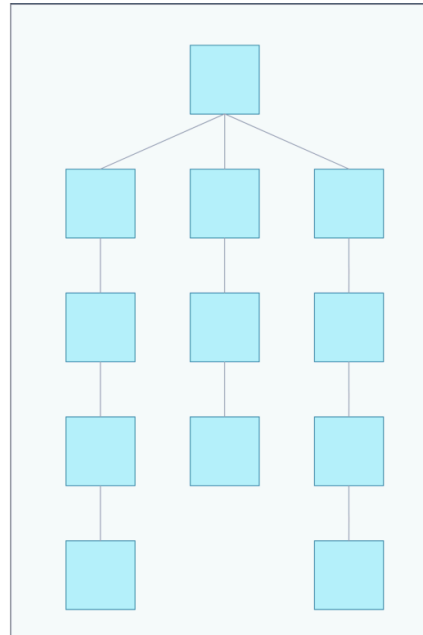
ID	Name	In-game description	Cost	Details	Previous nodes	Next nodes	Notes
A1	Peasant	Gain one pawn	1	Buyer: add one pawn to their side of the board	NONE (starting node)	A2 / A5	
A2	Checkers ?	Gain one checkers piece	2	Buyer: add one checkers piece to their side of the board	A1	A3	

A3	Stonks?!	Gain one knight Opponent gains one pawn	1	Buyer: add one knight to their side of the board Opponent: add one pawn to their side of the board	A2	A4	
A4	Shogi?	Gain one lance	2	Buyer: add a lance from shogi to their side of the board	A3	NONE (last node for now)	
A5	Expansion	Expand board by one	1	Expand the size of the board by one row and column on each side	A1	A6	
A6	More land!	Expand board by two	2	Expand the size of the board by two rows and columns on each side	A5	NONE (last node for now)	
B1	There can only be one	Sacrifice one pawn Opponent sacrifices one pawn	1	Both players: sacrifice one piece	NONE (starting node)		
B2	knighthood	Sacrifice two pawns Gain a knight	2	Buyer: Sacrifice two pawns to add a knight			
B3	Disguise	Transform a rook into a bishop	2	Buyer: transform a rook into a bishop			
B4	Disguise but reverse	Transform a bishop into a rook	2	Buyer: transform a bishop into a rook			
C1	Promotion	Promote a pawn to a queen	3	Buyer: promote one pawn to a queen	NONE (starting node)		

C2	My precious	Gain control of enemy piece (except king or queen)	3	Buyer: gain control of target enemy piece (except the king or queen)			
C3	Deadtouch	Add deadtouch to piece	2	Buyer: choose a piece to add the deadtouch property to			Deadtouch: If this piece is captured, the piece that captured is captured as well
C4	Trample	Add trample to piece	2	Buyer: Target piece gets trample			Trample: Gain the properties of the knight, being able to skip through ally pieces
D1	Debuff		1		NONE (starting node)		
D2	Temporary royalty	Promote a pawn for three turns		Buyer: a pawn is promoted (regular promotion) temporarily for three turns			
D3	Let me do it again	Take another turn after this one		Buyer: take another turn after this one (consumes action?)			
D4	Rise!	Create a wall tile		Buyer: transform a tile into a wall			Wall tile: section
D5	Get out of my swamp!	Create a swamp tile		Buyer: Transform a normal tile into a poison tile			Poison tile: section

E1	Ruling	Pawns can move three spaces for the first move	1	Pawns can now move three tiles when they move for the first time	NONE (starting node)		
E2	Gambling addiction	Pawns now have a chance of promotion when capturing		Pawns have a 10% chance of being promoted when capturing a piece			
E3	"Hello there"	A random piece is sacrificed every turn		Every turn a random tile of the board is selected: any piece on this tile (except for the king) is lost			
E4	Friendly fire	Players can now capture their own pieces		Players can capture their own pieces in addition to the opponent's pieces (still gaining capturing points)			
E5	Tactical Advantage	Every piece is now worth +1 for the buyer		Buyer: Enemy pieces are now worth +1 of the original points			
	Ruuuun!	There is now a chance of a piece to move again after capturing		Both players: Adds 25% of piece to be able to move again after capturing			

7.3. Planification



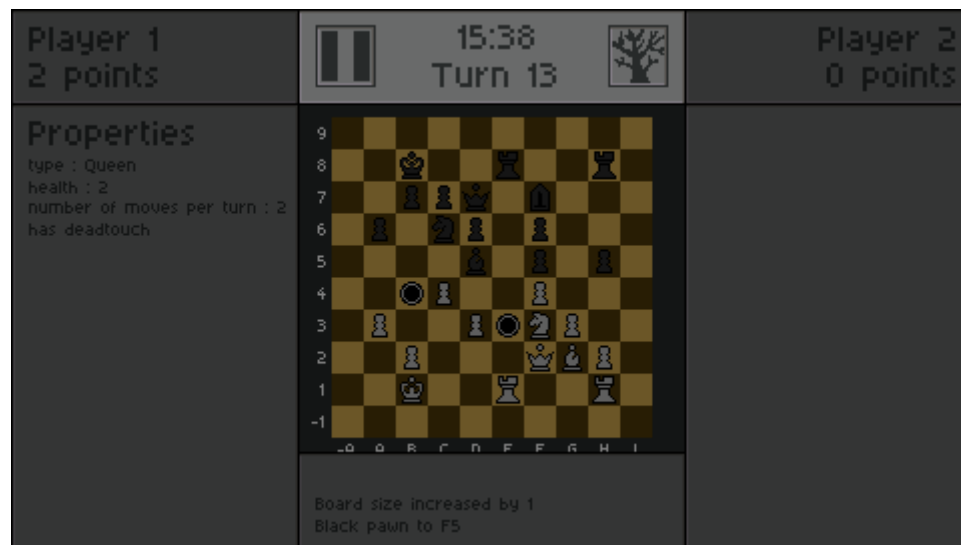
Basic idea of the structure of the upgrade tree

8. UI

8.1. Pause / Turn Number / Game Switch Button

This small tab contains:

- A button that when pressed pauses the game and pops up the pause menu
- A button that when pressed switches between the game board and the upgrade tree
- A turn counter that displays the number of the current turn on the game that adds one whenever the first player's turn starts



8.2. Player Info

Two tabs that each show the player's information:

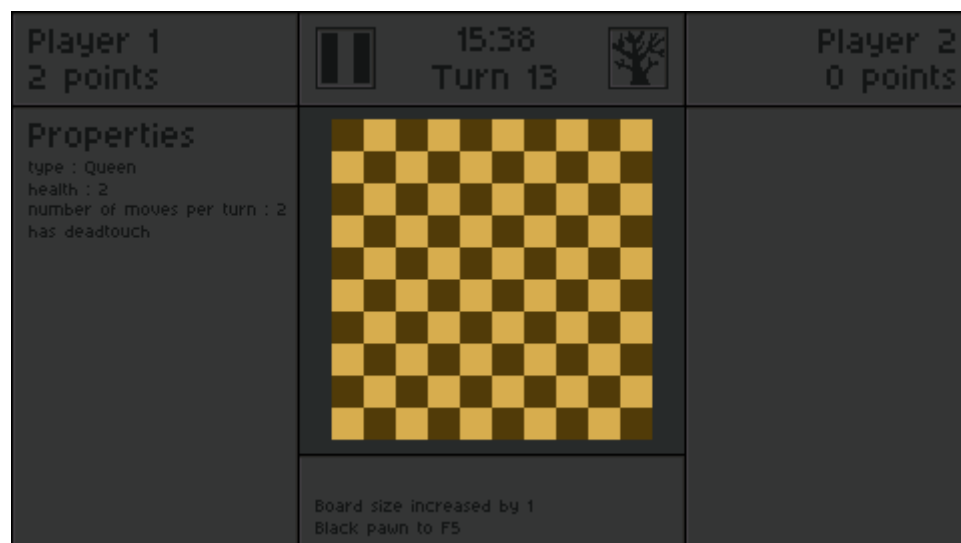
- The player's name (player 1 and player 2)
- The player's amount of capturing points
- A button that when pressed lets the player surrender - pops up a window that confirms the choice



8.3. Game / Upgrade Tree Window

The main window of the game: displays either the game board or the upgrade tree. Pressing the game switch button switches between the two.

Both maps are scrollable and can be zoomed in and out freely. To slide the map, the player must hold the right or middle button of the mouse and drag it. To zoom in or out the player can scroll the wheel of the mouse.



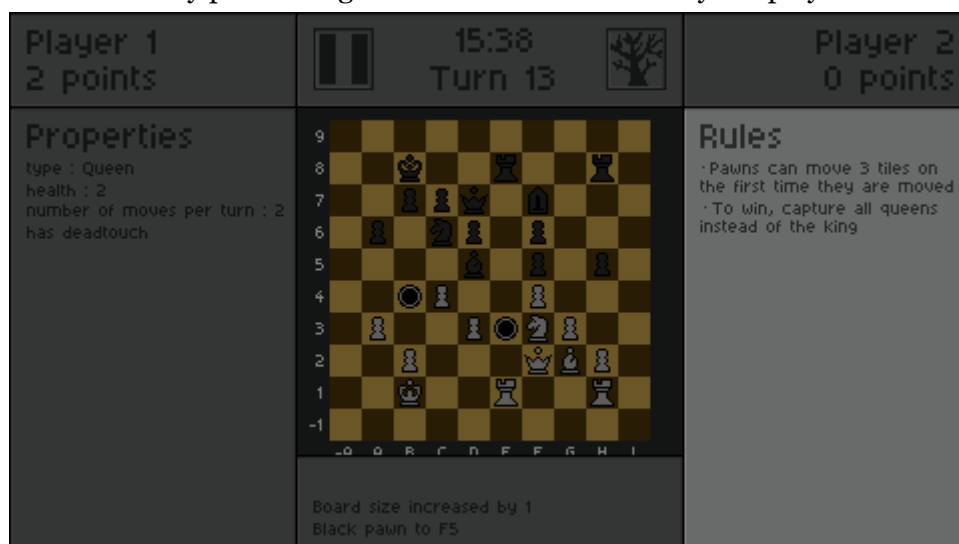
8.4. Properties Tab

Left clicking on a tile of the board switches between showing the properties of that piece / tile, starting with the piece if there is one in that tile.



8.5. Active Rules Tab

Shows the active rules of the game, these can be original rules from the game of chess or added rules unlocked by purchasing nodes from the skill tree by the players



8.6. History Tab

Displays the log of the game, this can be a piece moving or an action taken on the upgrade tree



9. Rules (and non traditional rules)

9.1. Capturing and points

Capturing an opponent piece awards capturing points.

Different pieces award different amounts of points

Refer to the following table for reference of the amount of points

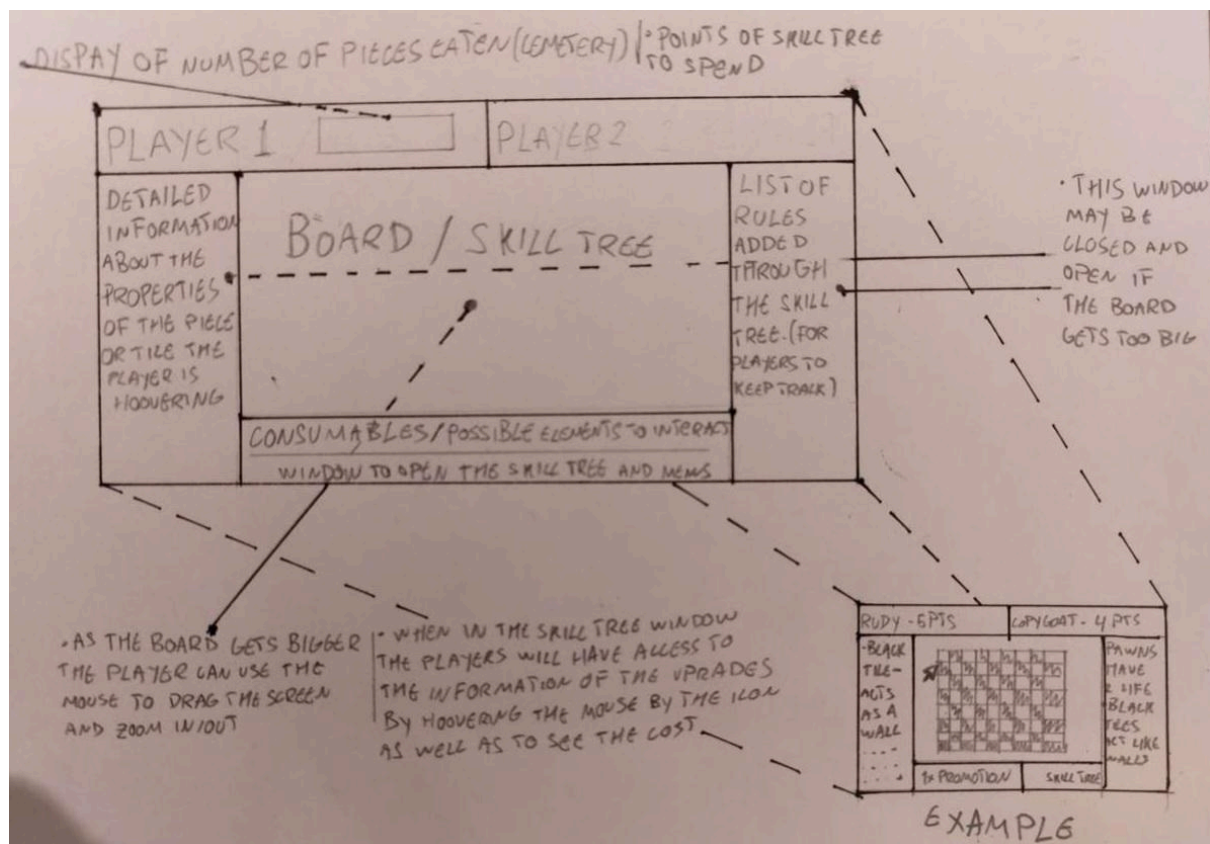
Piece	Points awarded
Pawn	1
Rook	2
Knight	2
Bishop	2
Queen	3
King	Win the game
Checkers piece	2
Lance	2

9.2. Promotion

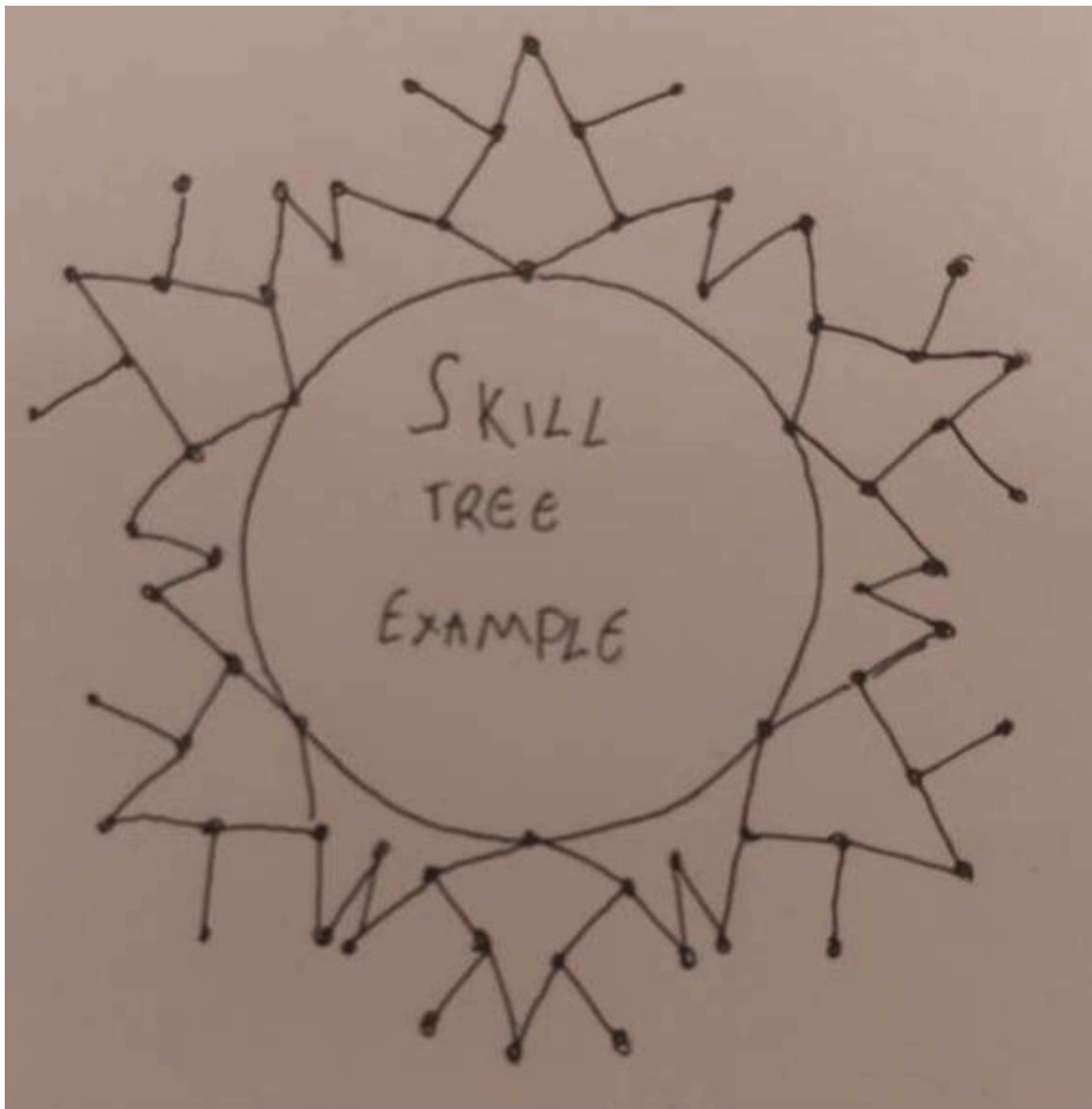
A piece is promoted when it reaches the opposite side of the board (for white, the piece needs to reach the 8th row). Each piece has different promotions, these are described in the piece's description section.

Moving the piece and promoting it happens on the same turn in that order.

10. Game State Sketches



Early sketch for the UI



Early sketch for the upgrade tree

11. Menus and Screens

This section describes the menus and screens that are not part of the main game menu (for main game menus and screens refer to the [UI section](#))

11.1. Main Menu

Buttons:

- Start: starts a match
- Options: displays the options of the game such as volume control.
- Credits: displays the names of the creators, supporters and materials used

11.2. Pause Menu

TODO - further development will be done once the game is on it's prototype phase

12. Art

12.1. Direction

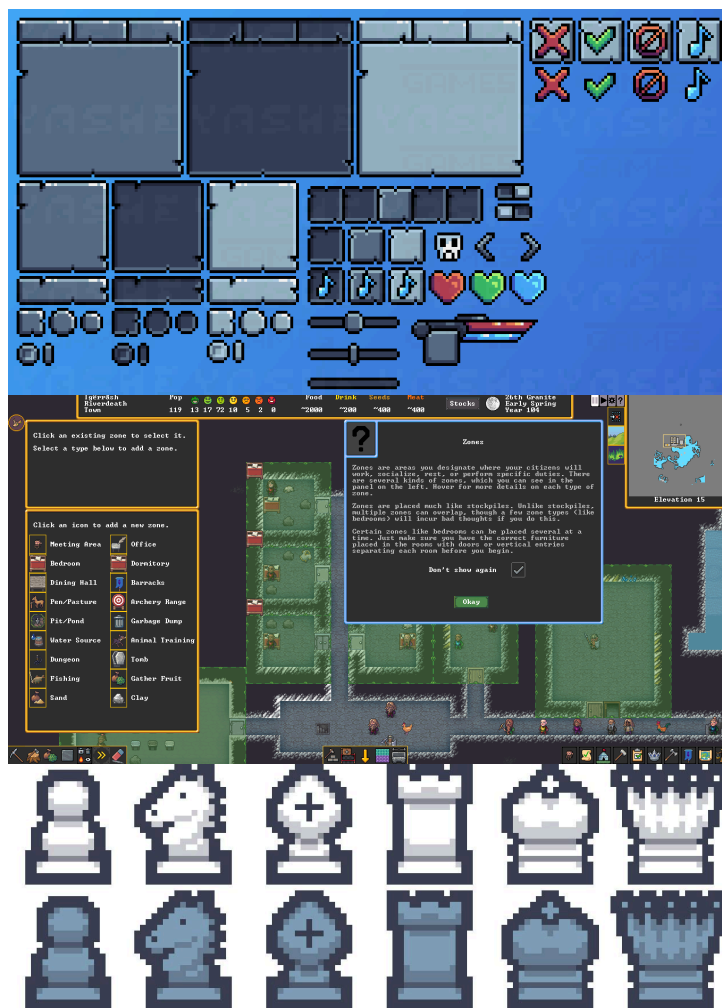
2D Pixel art

Simple textures

Arcade like

Medieval stone theme

12.2. Reference Images



13. Audio

13.1. Direction

Arcade Blues-like music

- in -game music
- Inspired by the game *Balatro*

“Stoney” sound effects:

- Pressing buttons on the menu
- Moving pieces

13.2. Table of Reference

Action	Description
Menu button click	A “tok”, sound of a stone hitting another something
Move piece	A “swoop”, quick dragging sound
Add piece	A “tok”, sound of a stone hitting another something
Capture piece	Reverse of adding a piece

14. Known Bugs / Unimplemented Features

As the game does not have a prototype, this section is not relevant

15. Glossary

[Board](#) - a grid of tiles where the game takes place, pieces exist on these tiles

[Piece](#) - a controllable character that belongs to either player

[Tile](#) - a unit of the board

[Upgrade tree](#) - a set of nodes connected to each other in a tree graph

[Node](#) - a purchasable action or ability that players can interact with once. Is locked when any of the previous connected nodes are not purchased

[Capturing point](#) - players can use these to purchase nodes, awarded when capturing the opponent's pieces

White / Player 1 - first player to start the game, pieces are visually colored white

Black / Player 2 - second player to start the game, pieces are visually colored black

[Action](#)

“Player’s side of the board” - This refers to the area that is the horizontal half of the board closest to the player mentioned

16. Brilliant ideas

Add rows / columns / change board size

Pawns have a chance to be promoted when capturing a non-pawn piece

Bring pieces back from the capturing zone

Pieces may capture others from the same team

Pieces gain more actions

Add other types of pieces from other games

Add promotions to other pieces besides the pawn

Gain control of target enemy piece

Add consumables like temporary promotions

Add properties to pieces like deadtouch (when captured, the capturing piece also dies)

Add more win conditions (exe.: King promotion, etc...)

Unpromote pieces

Building that adds pieces every turn

Monopoply

Disable pieces